

# **Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer**

## **Problem Statement:**

The current IT procurement process lacks efficiency and automation, resulting in delays and manual overhead, particularly in handling standard laptop orders. Requests for standard laptops often require configuration, but this step is prone to oversight or delay, leading to frustration among users and inefficient resource allocation within the IT department.

## **User Story:**

As a member of the IT procurement team, I want a streamlined process for ordering standard laptops so that tasks are automatically generated and assigned to the hardware team for configuration. This will ensure that laptops are promptly configured upon arrival, reducing user wait times and minimising manual intervention.

## **Project Objective:**

The objective of this project is to implement an automated workflow using Flow Designer to facilitate the procurement and configuration of standard laptops. By integrating automation into the process, the project aims to:

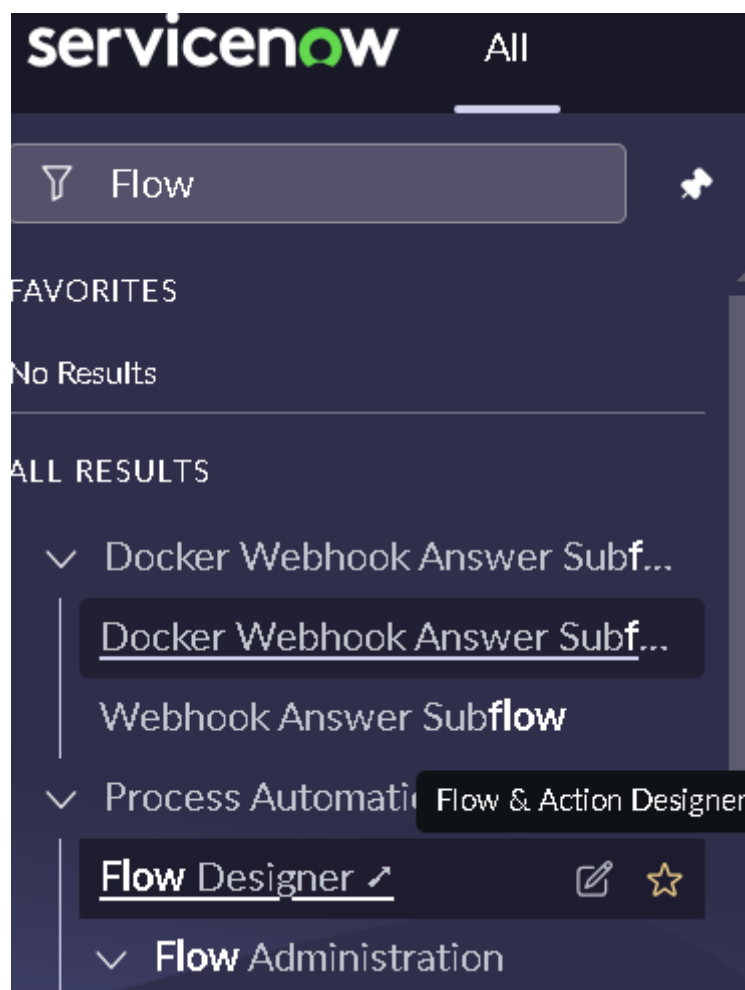
1. Create a seamless experience for users requesting standard laptops by ensuring timely configuration.
2. Reduce manual intervention and potential errors in the procurement process.
3. Improve resource utilisation within the IT department by optimising task allocation.
4. Enhance overall efficiency and productivity in IT procurement operations.

## TASK INITIATION

### Milestone 1 : Flow

**Activity 1: Create a Flow to Create Catalog task to update the short description after Approval the service Request and it will be Assignment group to Hardware.**

1. Open service now.
2. Click on All >> search for Flow Designer
3. Click on Flow Designer under Process Automation.
4. After opening Flow Designer Click on new and select Flow.
5. Under Flow properties Give Flow Name as “ Standard laptop task”.
6. Application should be Global.
7. Select Run user as “ System user ” from that choice.
8. Click on Submit.





servicenow Flow Designer

Flows Subflows Actions Executions Connections Help

New ▾

- Flow
- Subflow
- Action
- Data Stream

Search Updated ▾ Search

All

|                          | Name                 | Internal name        | Application | Status    | Active | Updated ▾           | Updated by |
|--------------------------|----------------------|----------------------|-------------|-----------|--------|---------------------|------------|
| <input type="checkbox"/> | Standard Laptop task | standard_laptop_task | Global      | Published | true   | 2024-04-16 23:33:53 | admin      |
| <input type="checkbox"/> | Email Sending For P1 | email_sending_for_p1 | Global      | Published | false  | 2024-04-16 04:22:31 | admin      |
| <input type="checkbox"/> | Daily Task Reminder  | daily_task_reminder  | Global      | Draft     | false  | 2024-04-16 00:08:03 | admin      |

## Flow properties

\* Flow name

Description

Application

Protection

Run As

9. Click on Add a trigger
10. Select the trigger in that Search for “ Service Catalog ” and select that.
11. After that click on Done.


Flow VPN
Flow Email sending for P1
Flow Standard laptop task
+


**Standard laptop task**
Inactive
View:  

#### TRIGGER

✕ Abort trigger creation

Trigger

Select a Trigger

Search triggers

**RECORD**

Created
Updated
Created or Updated

**DATE**

Daily

**Created**

Trigger initiates from a ServiceNow record creation that meets the condition filter.

ACTIONS

+ Add an Action, Flow

ERROR HANDLER

#### TRIGGER


Service Catalog
 

Trigger

Service Catalog

Advanced Options

Delete Cancel Done

12. Now under Actions.
13. Click on Add an action.
14. Select action in that search for “ Create Catalog Task ” and select that.
15. Mention these in that action
16. Action as Create Catalog Task
17. Drag and drop the Requested Item Record in the Request item.
18. Table will be auto populated as a Catalog Task.
19. Mention the short description as “ Laptop need to Configured ”.
20. Click on add field value
21. Select description field and value as “ Laptop need to Configured ”.
22. Select Assignment group field and value as “ Hardware ”.
23. Select Approval field and value as “ Approved ”.
24. Leave the remaining as default and click on Done.
25. Click on save the Flow.
26. And Click on Activate again click on Activate.

## Standard Laptop task Active

✕ Action Flow Logic Subflow

Search Actions Create Catalog Task

ERROR HANDLING  
If an error occurs

**Most Recent**

**Popular**

**INSTALLED SPOKES**

- ServiceNow Core
- Connect
- AES Portal UI Template
- Deployment Pipeline
- Virtual Agent
- Password Reset
- AES Flow Templates
- Global

**Create Catalog Task**  
ServiceNow Core

**Look Up Record**  
ServiceNow Core

**Wait For Condition**  
ServiceNow Core

**Create Record**  
ServiceNow Core

**SLA Percentage Timer**  
ServiceNow Core

**Send Email**  
ServiceNow Core

**Update Record**  
ServiceNow Core

**Create Template**  
ServiceNow Core

Standard Laptop task Active View: [Icon] [Icon] | Test De

1 **Create Catalog Task** [Icon]

Action: Create Catalog Task

Table Name: Catalog Task [sc\_task]

\* Requested Item [Requested Item]: Trigger - ... Requested Item ...

Short Description: Laptop needs to Configured

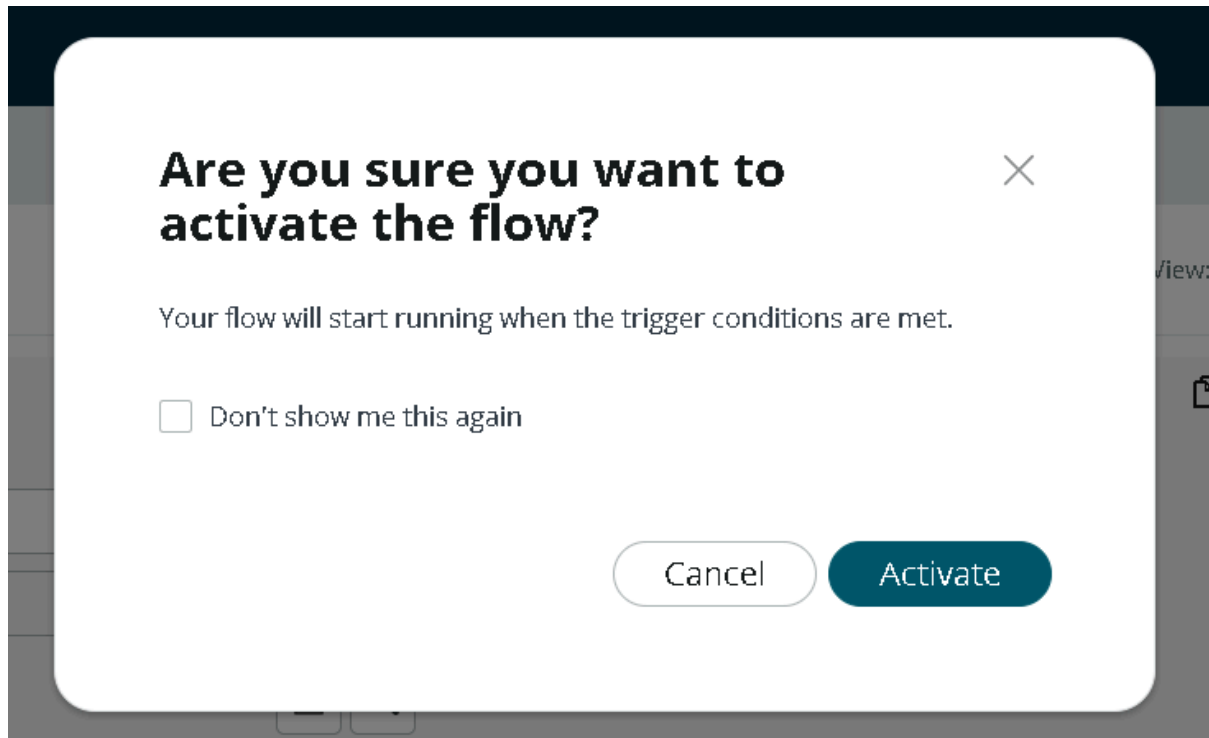
Fields:

|                  |                            |
|------------------|----------------------------|
| Description      | Laptop needs to Configured |
| Assignment group | Hardware                   |
| Approval         | Approved                   |

+ Add field value

Wait: ☒

Template Catalog: Select Template Catalog Item



## Milestone 2 : Flow assignment

### Activity 1 : Flow Assignment to Standard laptop service Catalog.

1. Open ServiceNow.
2. Click on all search for Maintain Items.
3. Select Maintain Items.
4. Under the name field search for Standard Laptop Select that record.
5. Under that record select Process engine
6. Remove the remaining automations and add Flow.
7. Add the flow that was created with the name “ Standard Laptop Task”.
8. Click on the menu to save the record.



servicenow

All

▼

mainta

➕

FAVORITES

No Results

ALL RESULTS

▼

Service Catalog

▼

Catalog Definitions

Maintain Catalogs

Maintain Categories

Maintain Dynamic Categories

Maintain Items

Maintain Cart Layouts

▼

Service Catalog Wizards

Maintain Wizards

Favorites

History

Workspaces

Admin

Catalog Items

☆

🔍 Search

⌵

🌐

🔗

🕒

👤

≡

🔍

Catalog Items

for text

🔍 Search

⊞

Actions on selected rows...

New

All > Type != Bundle > Class != Order guide > Type != Package > Class != Content Item > Published item is empty > Name starts with standard

| <input type="checkbox"/> | 🔍 | Name                 | Short description                           | Active | Roles  | Catalogs        | Category    | Price      | Type      | Updated             |
|--------------------------|---|----------------------|---------------------------------------------|--------|--------|-----------------|-------------|------------|-----------|---------------------|
| <input type="checkbox"/> | 🔍 | standard             | Search                                      | Search | Search | Search          | Search      | Search     | !=Package | Search              |
|                          |   | Standard Laptop      | Lenovo - Carbon x1                          | true   |        | Service Catalog | Hardware    | \$1,100.00 | Item      | 2024-04-16 04:14:53 |
|                          |   | Standard 27" Monitor | Size - 27", Resolution - 1920x1080, ...     | true   |        | Service Catalog | Peripherals | \$0.00     | Item      | 2022-11-20 20:46:33 |
|                          |   | Standard 22" Monitor | Full HD, IPS Panel with VGA, HDMI, DVI, ... | true   |        | Service Catalog | Peripherals | \$200.00   | Item      | 2016-03-08 16:49:50 |
|                          |   | Standard 24" Monitor | TUV-certified Monitor Has Flicker-free S... | true   |        | Service Catalog | Peripherals | \$292.28   | Item      | 2022-11-20 20:46:33 |

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Catalog Item  
Standard Laptop

Update

Copy

Try It

Edit in Catalog Builder

De

Name

Standard Laptop

Application

Global

Catalogs

Service Catalog

Active

☒

Category

Hardware

State

-- None --

Checked out

-- None --

Owner

Fulfillment automation level

Unspecified

Item Details

Process Engine

Picture

Pricing

Portal Settings

Select the appropriate process engine for the catalog Item. Only one engine can be selected.

Flow

Standard Laptop task

Workflow

Execution Plan

Update

Copy

Try It

Edit in Catalog Builder

Delete

## Milestone 3 : Service Catalog

### Activity 1: Service Catalog for placing order and get Approval

1. Click on All >> Search for “ Service Catalog ”.
2. Click on Service Catalog >> click on Hardware.
3. Scroll a bit to find the “ Standard Laptop ” click on that.
4. After that click on “ Order Now ” to place the request.



[Favorites](#) [History](#) [Workspaces](#) [Admin](#) [Standard Laptop](#) [Search](#)

[Service Catalog](#) > [Hardware](#) > [Standard Laptop](#) [Search catalog](#)

### Lenovo - Carbon x1

**x1 Carbon**

The x1 Carbon is Lenovo's lightest ThinkPad yet. It provides a QHD display that fights glare and weighs less than three pounds. Ideal for most computing tasks, and highly mobile.

Technical Specs:

- Intel core i5 processor
- 512GB solid state drive (SSD)
- Backlit keyboard

Optional Software

☐ Adobe Acrobat

☐ Adobe Photoshop

Additional software requirements

**Order this Item**

**Price** ₹91,931.2306 + ₹8,357.3846 Annually

**Quantity** 1

**Subtotal** ₹91,931.2306 + ₹8,357.3846 Annually

**Delivery t** [Order Now](#) 0 Days

[Order Now](#)

[Add to Cart](#)

**Shopping Cart**

Empty

- Now we will see the Order status
- In that click on the Request Number

[Order Status](#) [Back to Catalog](#) [Continue Shopping](#) [Home](#)

✔ Thank you, your request has been submitted

Order Placed: 2024-04-17 04:07:11

Request Number: [REQ0010001](#) ☆

Estimated Delivery Date of Complete Order: 2024-04-17

| Description (Includes Annual Charges) | Delivery Date | Stage | Price (ea.)                           | Quantity     | Total                                         |
|---------------------------------------|---------------|-------|---------------------------------------|--------------|-----------------------------------------------|
| <a href="#">Lenovo - Carbon x1</a>    | 2024-04-17    | ▶     | ₹91,931.2306<br>+₹8,357.3846 Annually | 1            | ₹91,931.2306<br>+₹8,357.3846 Annually         |
|                                       |               |       |                                       | <b>Total</b> | <b>₹91,931.2306<br/>+₹8,357.3846 Annually</b> |

[Back to Catalog](#) [Continue Shopping](#) [Home](#)

- It will open the Requested number record.
- Scroll down Click on the Approvers Section.

Request - REQ0010001

Short description

Special instructions

Update Add New Item Cancel Request Copy Delete

Related Links  
[Show Workflow](#)  
[Workflow Context](#)

Requested Items (1) **Approvers (1)** Recurring Prices (1)

Approval for = REQ0010001

| State     | Approver       | Comments | Created             |
|-----------|----------------|----------|---------------------|
| Requested | Eric Schroeder |          | 2024-04-17 04:07:12 |

1 to 1 of 1

9. Right Click on the Record to see config in that Click on the Approve.

Update Add New Item Cancel Request Copy Delete

Related Links  
[Show Workflow](#)  
[Workflow Context](#)

Requested Items (1) **Approvers (1)** Recurring Prices (1)

Approval for = REQ0010001

| State     | Approver       | Comments | Created             |
|-----------|----------------|----------|---------------------|
| Requested | Eric Schroeder |          | 2024-04-17 04:07:12 |

1 to 1 of 1

10. Then click on the Requested item Section

11. Open that Requested Item record

Request Item - RITM0010001

Activities: 1

System Administrator

Field changes • 2024-04-17 04:07:10

Impact 3 - Low  
 Opened by System Administrator  
 Priority 4 - Low  
 State Open

Update Delete

Related Links  
[Flow Context](#)

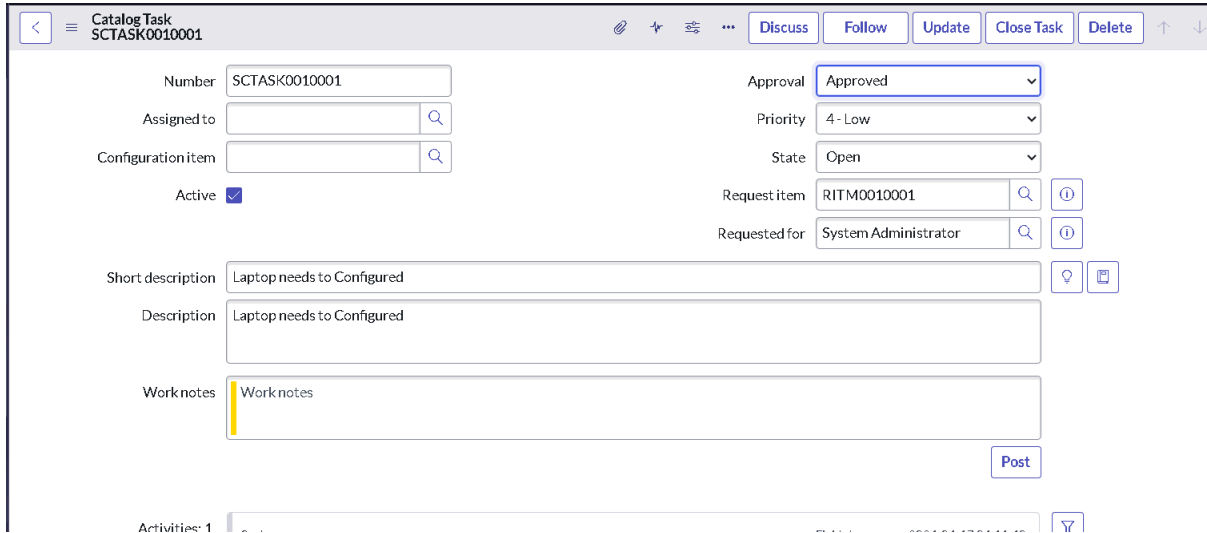
Catalog Tasks (1) **Approvers** Group approvals

Request item = RITM0010001

| Number        | Assignment group | Assigned to | Short description          | Actual start        | Actual end | Order |
|---------------|------------------|-------------|----------------------------|---------------------|------------|-------|
| SCTASK0010001 | Hardware         | (empty)     | Laptop needs to Configured | 2024-04-17 04:11:40 | (empty)    |       |

1 to 1 of 1

12. Scroll down to the “ Catalog tasks ” Section
13. Open the record to see the updated status of the record with Short description and Assigned group.



The screenshot displays a ServiceNow Catalog Task record for SCTASK0010001. The interface includes a top navigation bar with buttons for Discuss, Follow, Update, Close Task, and Delete. The record details are organized into two columns. The left column contains fields for Number (SCTASK0010001), Assigned to, Configuration item, Active (checked), Short description (Laptop needs to Configured), Description (Laptop needs to Configured), and Worknotes (Work notes). The right column contains fields for Approval (Approved), Priority (4 - Low), State (Open), Request item (RITM0010001), and Requested for (System Administrator). A Post button is located at the bottom right of the Worknotes field. The bottom of the screen shows an Activities section with a list of activities.

| Field              | Value                               |
|--------------------|-------------------------------------|
| Number             | SCTASK0010001                       |
| Assigned to        |                                     |
| Configuration item |                                     |
| Active             | <input checked="" type="checkbox"/> |
| Short description  | Laptop needs to Configured          |
| Description        | Laptop needs to Configured          |
| Worknotes          | Work notes                          |
| Approval           | Approved                            |
| Priority           | 4 - Low                             |
| State              | Open                                |
| Request item       | RITM0010001                         |
| Requested for      | System Administrator                |

## Conclusion :

By automating the standard laptop procurement process with ServiceNow's Flow Designer, the project effectively addresses inefficiencies and reduces manual overhead. This streamlined workflow ensures timely configuration of laptops, minimizes user wait times, and enhances overall productivity within the IT department. The implementation of this automated solution not only optimizes resource allocation but also significantly improves the user experience by providing a seamless and efficient procurement process.

